Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Thursday, 22 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Drizzle	Rain	Light rain	Drizzle
14° 9°	12° 7°	11° 6°	11° 6°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Former DUP leader Jeffrey Donaldson is being investigated over an alleged rape that is said to have happened inside Parliament.**

The Metropolitan Police has confirmed they are investigating a 63-year-old man, though they have not named the disgraced former MP. This serious allegation is now making headlines across the UK.

CRIME · UK

2 **A lawyer has been caught on camera offering to make a hefty illegal-worker fine disappear, sparking a major government review.**

The Home Secretary has ordered a review into how fines are issued and collected, following an investigation that revealed the lawyer's claims to an undercover reporter. It's a shocking insight into alleged loopholes.

LAW · UK

3 **A teenage boy has been found guilty of attempting to murder a 15-year-old girl at a school, leading to a campus lockdown.**

The incident caused widespread panic as parents gathered at the gates, desperate for news about their children. The court case has brought the terrifying events back into focus.

CRIME · UK

4 **An amber weather warning has been issued for parts of the UK as Storm Austen threatens strong winds and heavy rain.**

The deep area of low pressure is expected to hit the south of the UK early on Friday, with south-west England likely to bear the brunt. Forecasters are urging people to be prepared for disruption.

WEATHER · UK

5 **Holocaust education in schools is set to be improved following a 'shocking' review into antisemitism.**

Education Secretary Lucy Powell has emphasised the critical importance of ensuring new generations understand the horrors of the Holocaust. It's a move welcomed by many.

EDUCATION · UK

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02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Get ready to sing along again, because the hit high school musical Glee is set for a reboot!**

Ryan Murphy's popular musical comedy-drama is making a comeback on Hulu and Disney+ after a decade away. Fans will be dusting off their sheet music and warming up their voices.

ON AIR — Who was your favourite Glee character, and what song are you hoping they'll cover in the reboot?

TV · COMING SOON

2 **Booyakasha! Sacha Baron Cohen is bringing back his iconic character Ali G, more than two decades after his last big screen outing.**

The creator of Borat and Bruno is reviving the Staines Massive's most famous resident. It's a return that will certainly get people talking and wondering if the character is still relevant today.

ON AIR — Do you think Ali G's humour has stood the test of time, or is it a character best left in the past?

COMEDY · COMING SOON

3 **Fans of Bridget Jones will be thrilled to hear that author Helen Fielding is launching an award to find the next diary-writing sensation.**

The Bridget Jones Prize will celebrate the funniest 1,000-word diary-style piece of writing. It's a brilliant way to unearth new talent and bring some much-needed humour to our lives.

ON AIR — If you were to write a diary entry, what's the funniest thing that's happened to you this week?

BOOKS · NEW

4 **Glastonbury coach ticket holders have had a bit of a wobble, as an admin error led to overselling.**

But fear not, all bookings will automatically be converted into general admission tickets, and the coach fare will be refunded. So, if you're heading to Worthy Farm, you're still going!

ON AIR — Are you a Glastonbury veteran, or is it on your bucket list? What's the one thing you can't go without at a festival?

MUSIC · FESTIVAL

5 **Kylie Jenner's debut at the Victoria's Secret Fashion Show, sporting a 50-million-dollar bra, has certainly sparked a reaction.**

The reality star's surprise appearance on the runway in the diamond-encrusted piece has prompted mixed responses. It's safe to say, she turned heads!

ON AIR — Do you think celebrity appearances at fashion shows add to the spectacle, or do you prefer to see professional models?

FASHION · EVENT

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Australia's cricketers are facing a monumental defeat in the second Test against South Africa, with their performance being described as 'shambolic'.**

After an extraordinary day four, careers are said to be on the line as Australia reel from their performance. It's a huge talking point in the world of cricket.

ON AIR — What's the most dramatic collapse you've ever seen in a sporting event?

CRICKET · GLOBAL

2 **England's all-time leading wicket-taker, James Anderson, may see his legendary career come to an end after Lancashire opted not to offer him a new contract.**

The 44-year-old hasn't been offered a new deal, leaving many to wonder if this is the final chapter for one of cricket's greats. It's a big moment for English cricket.

ON AIR — If this is the end for James Anderson, where does he rank among England's greatest ever cricketers?

CRICKET · UK

3 **Formula 1 Grands Prix are set to return to their standard distance in 2028, after a shorter maximum length was introduced for next season.**

This change will mean longer, more traditional races for fans. It's a move that's likely to be welcomed by purists of the sport.

ON AIR — Are you in favour of longer F1 races, or do you think the shorter format has its advantages?

F1 · GLOBAL

4 **England's star full-back Ellie Kildunne has been dropped to the bench as the team makes changes following their first defeat in four years.**

The Red Roses are shaking up their selection in response to a rare loss. It shows the pressure is on to get back to winning ways.

ON AIR — When a team faces a setback, is it better to stick with the same line-up or make bold changes?

RUGBY · UK

5 **Katie Boulter has powered into the quarter-finals of the Japan Open, winning her match in under an hour.**

She beat Viktorija Golubic in a dominant performance, showing she's in excellent form. It's a great result for the British tennis star.

ON AIR — What's your favourite Grand Slam or tennis tournament to watch?

TENNIS · GLOBAL

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **More of us are learning the names of the birds in our gardens, apps report.**
Bird-ID apps have made spotting easier. The robin remains the nation's clear favourite, mostly for its cheek.

2 **A survey says most of us secretly prefer a night in with a quiz on the telly to a night out.**
Shouting answers at the screen remains the nation's favourite low-effort sport — even when we're completely wrong.

3 **More than half of UK workers would take a 10% pay cut to never go into the office again — but only 17% of bosses say they'd offer one.**
The gap is growing again after forced return-to-office rules. HR experts say the tension shows up in resignation rates, particularly for under-35s.

4 **A poll finds most people have a song that instantly makes them feel like dancing, even in the kitchen.**
Kitchen discos are a quiet national pastime. The wooden spoon remains the microphone of choice.

5 **62% of us have lied about reading a book to look smart in front of someone we fancy.**
Most-faked titles: 1984, Pride and Prejudice and (awkwardly) the Bible. One in five admit to faking a whole dinner-party conversation about a novel they'd only seen the cover of.

6 **Half of UK adults can't name a single member of the cabinet — but 80% can name three Love Island contestants.**
Political engagement researchers say it's not apathy so much as 'noise overload'. People remember faces from things they actively watch.

7 **The average Brit checks their phone 159 times a day — but says it 'doesn't feel like that much'.**
Researchers using passive monitoring apps say we badly underestimate our own usage. Most people guess between 30 and 70 times.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **66% of us have pretended to be busy to avoid THIS.**
ANSWER: HELPING SOMEONE MOVE HOUSE.

Q **The most common thing we forget the moment we walk into a room is THIS.**
ANSWER: WHY WE WALKED INTO THE ROOM.

TALK TOPIC

- **A survey says most of us have given a nickname to a stranger we see regularly.**
  Who's the person on your route you've secretly named — and what did you call them?
- **Apparently the average person changes their mind about their favourite biscuit three times in a lifetime.**
  What's your current number one — and what's it knocked off the top spot?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Science.** Lightning strikes the Earth roughly 8 million times a day — about 100 times every second somewhere on the planet.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A weather station in the Lake District has had to relocate after its rain gauge kept overflowing so often that staff started using it to water the office plants.

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06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£59 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£59 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Octopuses have three hearts and blue blood.
- The inventor of the frisbee was turned into a frisbee after he died — his ashes were moulded into one.
- A jiffy is a real unit of time: one hundredth of a second.
- Bubble wrap was originally invented to be wallpaper.
- The Hawaiian alphabet has just 13 letters.
- Sea otters have a pouch of loose skin under each arm to store food and a favourite rock.
- The longest hiccupping fit on record lasted around 68 years.
- Tomatoes were once feared in Europe and nicknamed the 'poison apple'.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES THU 22 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 295 of the year, 70 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abercius of Hieropolis; Christian feast day: Cordula of Cologne; Christian feast day: Donatus of Fiesole; Christian feast day: Marcus of Jerusalem. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1974 — Tim Kinsella, American singer-songwriter
- 1964 — TobyMac, American singer-songwriter and producer
- 1971 — Jennifer Lee, American filmmaker
- 1942 — Annette Funicello, American actress and singer (died 2013)
- 1980 — Niall Breslin, Irish singer-songwriter, guitarist, producer, and footballer
- 1958 — Bobby Blotzer, American drummer
- 1972 — Saffron Burrows, English-American actress
- 1962 — Bob Odenkirk, American actor and comedian

THE DAY TODAY

- 1963 — A BAC One-Eleven prototype airliner crashes in UK with the loss of all on board.
- 2005 — Bellview Airlines Flight 210 crashes in Nigeria, killing all 117 people on board.
- 1962 — Cuban Missile Crisis: President Kennedy, after internal counsel from Dwight D. Eisenhower, announces that American reconnaissance planes have discovered Soviet nuclear weapons in Cuba, and that he has ordered a naval "quarantine" of the Communist nation.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1983 — Two correctional officers are killed by inmates at the United States Penitentiary in Marion, Illinois. The incident inspires the Supermax model of prisons.
- 1996 — Millon Air Flight 406 crashes after takeoff from Eloy Alfaro International Airport in Manta, Ecuador, killing 34 people.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1962 — Cuban Missile Crisis: President Kennedy, after internal counsel from Dwight D. Eisenhower, announces that American reconnaissance planes have discovered Soviet nuclear weapons in Cuba, and that he has ordered a naval "quarantine" of the Communist nation.

- 2012 — Cyclist Lance Armstrong is formally stripped of his seven Tour de France titles after being charged for doping.
- 2014 — Michael Zehaf-Bibeau attacks the Parliament of Canada, killing a soldier and injuring three other people.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES FRI 23 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 296 of the year, 69 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Feast of the Most Holy Redeemer; Christian feast day: James the Just (i.e. James, brother of Jesus) (Lutheran, Episcopal Church (USA), Eastern Orthodox); Christian feast day: Æthelflæd of Romsey; Christian feast day: Allucio of Campugliano. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1957 — Graham Rix, English footballer and coach
- 1976 — Cat Deeley, English model, actress, and television host
- 1978 — Steve Harmison, English cricketer and sportscaster
- 1973 — Christian Dailly, Scottish footballer
- 1944 — Mike Harding, English singer-songwriter and comedian
- 1984 — Keiren Westwood, English footballer
- 1940 — Jane Holzer, American model, actress, producer, and art collector
- 1986 — Jessica Stroup, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1989 — Bankruptcy of Wärtsilä Marine, the biggest bankruptcy in the Nordic countries up until then.
- 1970 — Gary Gabelich sets a land speed record in a rocket-powered automobile called the Blue Flame, fueled with natural gas.
- 2020 — Second Libyan Civil War: The Second Libyan Civil War comes to an end as all parties to the 5+5 Joint Libyan Military Commission agree to a ceasefire.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2001 — Apple Computer releases the iPod.
- 1995 — Yolanda Saldívar is found guilty of first-degree murder in the shooting death of popular Latin singer Selena.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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